

Construction and Architecture English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: architects, construction managers, project engineers, site supervisors, estimators, owners' representatives, subcontractor coordinators, and design-build teams

Focus: A construction and architecture English curriculum for design intent, RFIs, change orders, site coordination, safety, schedule pressure, permitting, punch lists, claims, and client communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Design Intent and Client Requirements

Situation

A client requests a major design change late in design development.

Stakeholder pressure: Update the drawings immediately.

Constraint: Scope, fee, schedule, code, and constructability implications need review.

Terms to use

- design intent
- program
- constructability
- scope

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A client requests a major design change late in design development.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Update the drawings immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm design intent, program, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	owner
C	design-change response
D	evidence

Module 2. Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Situation

A subcontractor says drawings conflict with specifications.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell them to follow the drawings.

Constraint: Contract documents, RFI process, schedule impact, and design response are needed.

Terms to use

- RFI
- specification
- drawing set
- submittal

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A subcontractor says drawings conflict with specifications.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell them to follow the drawings.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm RFI, specification, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	RFI response summary
B	evidence
C	risk
D	owner

Module 3. Change Orders and Cost Control**Situation**

A subcontractor submits a change order for hidden conditions.

Stakeholder pressure: Reject it because the budget is tight.

Constraint: Contract terms, notice, evidence, schedule, and pricing must be reviewed.

Terms to use

- change order
- allowance
- contingency

- notice

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A subcontractor submits a change order for hidden conditions.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Reject it because the budget is tight.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm change order, allowance, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	mitigation
B	approval
C	control
D	change-order evaluation

Module 4. Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Situation

Steel delivery delay threatens enclosure work.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask all trades to recover the time.

Constraint: Critical path, float, resequencing, crew availability, and weather risk matter.

Terms to use

- critical path
- float
- lookahead schedule
- resequencing

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Steel delivery delay threatens enclosure work.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask all trades to recover the time.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm critical path, float, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	schedule impact update
B	toolbox safety talk
C	inspection correction plan
D	punch-list closeout plan

Module 5. Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Situation

A crew works at height without proper fall protection.

Stakeholder pressure: Remind them quickly and continue.

Constraint: Safety requirements, stop-work authority, training, and documentation apply.

Terms to use

- PPE
- fall protection
- toolbox talk
- stop work

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A crew works at height without proper fall protection.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Remind them quickly and continue.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm PPE, fall protection, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	mitigation
B	approval
C	control

Option	Phrase
D	toolbox safety talk

Module 6. Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Situation

An inspector rejects an installation detail.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the inspector to be flexible.

Constraint: Code interpretation, approved drawings, corrective work, and reinspection are required.

Terms to use

- permit
- inspection
- code compliance
- reinspection

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

An inspector rejects an installation detail.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the inspector to be flexible.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm permit, inspection, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	schedule impact update
B	inspection correction plan
C	RFI response summary
D	change-order evaluation

Module 7. Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Situation

The client wants occupancy while punch items remain.

Stakeholder pressure: Hand over the space anyway.

Constraint: Life safety, substantial completion, warranties, and closeout documents need clarity.

Terms to use

- punch list
- substantial completion
- warranty
- closeout

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

The client wants occupancy while punch items remain.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Hand over the space anyway.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm punch list, substantial completion, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	punch-list closeout plan
B	timeline
C	assumption
D	mitigation

Module 8. Claims, Disputes, and Documentation**Situation**

A delay dispute emerges after months of informal changes.

Stakeholder pressure: Argue from memory.

Constraint: Daily reports, notices, photos, meeting minutes, and contract language matter.

Terms to use

- claim
- daily report
- meeting minutes
- entitlement

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A delay dispute emerges after months of informal changes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Argue from memory.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm claim, daily report, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	disclosure
B	design-change response
C	RFI response summary
D	claim chronology

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Design Intent and Client Requirements

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. design-change response	A design-change response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. RFI response summary	A RFI response summary is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Change Orders and Cost Control

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. change-order evaluation	A change-order evaluation is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. schedule impact update	A schedule impact update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. toolbox safety talk	A toolbox safety talk is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. inspection correction plan	A inspection correction plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. punch-list closeout plan	A punch-list closeout plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. claim chronology	A claim chronology is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.